RILEY K. KENDALL

Doctoral Candidate, Behavioral Neuroscience | Part-Time Lecturer, Psychology and Physical Therapy
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EDUCATION

University of California, Los Angeles **Expected 2027**
Ph.D., Behavioral Neuroscience (Psychology); GPA: 4.0
- Doctoral candidate; advanced to candidacy Spring 2025.
- M.A., Psychology, 2022.

Chapman University **2021**
M.S., Computational and Data Sciences; GPA: 3.98

Chapman University **2020**
B.S., Biochemistry and Molecular Biology, magna cum laude; Minor: Computational Neuroscience; GPA: 3.82

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Part-Time Lecturer **2024-Present**
Chapman University, Departments of Psychology and Physical Therapy
- Instructor of record for upper-division undergraduate Physiological Psychology.
- Co-instructor for Functional Human Neuroscience II in the Doctor of Physical Therapy program with primary responsibility for developing and teaching half of the course curriculum and assessments.
- Design and deliver lectures, apply learning activities and assessments across undergraduate and doctoral-professional programs.
- Supervise and mentor undergraduate teaching assistants in course facilitation, student support, and pedagogical development; three TAs have developed teaching-related posters for Chapman's TA Poster Fair, including one presented in Spring 2026 and two forthcoming in Fall 2026.

Graduate Student Researcher **2021-Present**
University of California, Los Angeles, Behavioral Neuroscience

Teaching Assistant **2022-2023**
University of California, Los Angeles, Department of Psychology
- Taught weekly sections in Pavlovian and instrumental learning, neuroanatomy, and introductory psychology; led reviews and assessed student work.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Behavioral Neuroscience Researcher **2021-Present**
University of California, Los Angeles
- Investigate neural and behavioral mechanisms of decision-making, motivation, learning, and memory in rat foraging tasks.
- Use electrophysiological recordings targeting the hippocampal region, computational modeling, and quantitative analysis.

Bioinformatics Researcher **2021**
Chapman University
- Studied SARS-CoV-2 Mpro and the potential role of natural products in preventing infection using BIOVIA and PyMOL.

Computational Neuroscience Research Intern **2020**
Allen Institute for Brain Science
- Compared gene expression in the M1 region across species using computational analysis in R.

Biochemistry Researcher, Catalyst Research Lab **2017-2020**
Chapman University
- Studied interactions between calmodulin and the MA matrix protein of HIV-1 Gag using fluorescence spectroscopy and anisotropy.

Biomedical Sciences Research Intern **2019**
Augusta University
- Researched signaling pathways in osteoblast cells from mice in controlled, in-vitro conditions, specifically investigating how osteoblasts respond to certain challenges and stresses and the role of bone marrow fat in age-related bone loss.

TEACHING INNOVATION AND SCHOLARSHIP

Immersive Physiological Psychology Case Studies **2026-Present**
Chapman University

- Designed and implemented two collaborative case-study activities that ask students to integrate physiological psychology concepts with clinical and contextual evidence.

PUBLICATIONS AND MANUSCRIPTS

Peer-Reviewed

Logue, R. S., Garcia, A. K., Bejarano, B. A., Fujioka, T., Duke, M., **Kendall, R. K.**, & Wikenheiser, A. M. (2025). Rats pursue food and leisure following the same rational principles. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences of the United States of America*, *122*(44), e2520884122. https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2520884122

Ang, D., **Kendall, R.,** & Atamian, H. S. (2023). Virtual and In Vitro Screening of Natural Products Identifies Indole and Benzene Derivatives as Inhibitors of SARS-CoV-2 Main Protease (M^{pro}). *Biology*, *12*(4), 519. https://doi.org/10.3390/biology12040519

Kendall, R. K., & Wikenheiser, A. M. (2022). Quitting while you're ahead: Patch foraging and temporal cognition. *Behavioral neuroscience*, *136*(5), 467–478. https://doi.org/10.1037/bne0000526

Pierce, J. L., Roberts, R. L., Yu, K., **Kendall, R. K.**, Kaiser, H., Davis, C., Johnson, M. H., Hill, W. D., Isales, C. M., Bollag, W. B., Hamrick, M. W., & McGee-Lawrence, M. E. (2020). Kynurenine suppresses osteoblastic cell energetics in vitro and osteoblast numbers in vivo. *Experimental Gerontology, 130*, 110818. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.exger.2019.110818

Manuscripts Under Review

Kendall, R. K. (under review). Designing immersive mystery case studies for applied learning in physiological psychology. *Journal of Undergraduate Neuroscience Education* (FUN workshop issue).

Manuscripts in Preparation

Kendall, R. K., Garcia, A. K., Bejarano, B. A., Alkire, A., Nguyen, J., Rafifar, R., Logue, R. S., Fujioka, T., & Wikenheiser, A. M. (in prep). *Adaptive patch-leaving but paradoxical patch-choice decisions in rats performing a spatial foraging task.*

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Kendall, R. K. *Designing immersive case studies to promote applied learning.* Oral presentation at the Faculty for Undergraduate Neuroscience (FUN) Summer Workshop, 2026.

Kendall, R. K., et al. *Comparing time and effort costs in a free-choice foraging task for rats.* Poster presented at the Society for Neuroscience Annual Meeting and the Decision-Making Affinity Group Symposium, 2024.

Kendall, R. K., et al. *Evaluating the effects of temporal and effort costs in foraging task decisions.* Poster presented at the UCLA Brain Research Institute Neuroscience Retreat, 2024.

Kendall, R. K., et al. *Evaluating the effects of temporal and effort costs in foraging task decisions.* Poster presented at the International Behavioral Neuroscience Society Annual Meeting, 2023.

AWARDS AND HONORS

National Science Foundation (NSF) Conference Travel Award **2026**
Student Mentored Research Fellowship (SMRF) **2023**
University of California, Los Angeles
Graduate Student Research Mentorship (GSRM) Award **2022**
University of California, Los Angeles
Biochemistry and Molecular Biology Honors Program **2020**
Chapman University
Cheverton Award Finalist, Outstanding Undergraduate **2020**
Chapman University
Outstanding Leadership Award **2020**
Schmid College of Science and Technology, Chapman University
Eldridge Award for Outstanding STAR Intern **2019**
Augusta University
Presidential Scholarship **2016-2020**
Chapman University

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT AND TRAINING

Center for the Integration of Research, Teaching and Learning (CIRTL) Associate Certification	**2026**
CIRTL Teaching and Learning Workshops	**2026**
Faculty for Undergraduate Neuroscience (FUN) Summer Workshop	**2026**
ERG 130: Cognitive Human Factors and Ergonomics	**2026**
ERG 110: Evidence-Based Human Factors and Ergonomics	**2025**
Neurological Preceptorship, Valley Health Winchester Medical Center	**2018**

CIRTL workshops: Rethinking Assessment Design in the Age of AI: A Practical Framework; Real-World and Hands-On Learning: Learning-Centered Teaching Strategies for Student Success; Research as a High-Impact Practice in STEM Education; Teaching Transferable Skills and Work-Integrated Learning in the College Classroom.
ERG courses: 8-week accelerated online courses in human factors and ergonomics offered through UC Berkeley's Center for Occupational and Environmental Health (COEH)

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Faculty for Undergraduate Neuroscience (FUN)	**2026-Present**
Society for Neuroscience (SfN)	**2023-2025**
International Behavioral Neuroscience Society (IBNS)	**2023**

TECHNICAL AND RESEARCH SKILLS

Programming and analysis: Python, R, MATLAB; mathematical modeling; mixed-effects models; machine learning; neural decoding; biostatistics; data visualization.

Neuroscience and laboratory methods: Electrophysiology; Neuropixels; SpikeGadgets; spike sorting and curation (Kilosort, Phy); Bonsai visual tracking; animal behavioral testing; stereotaxic surgery (neural implants, viral injections); histology; fluorescence microscopy; fluorescence spectroscopy.

Teaching and leadership: Curriculum and course development; evidence-based teaching; active learning; assessment design; lecturing; undergraduate mentorship; scientific communication; leadership; adaptability

SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

Undergraduate Research Mentor **2023-Present**

University of California, Los Angeles

- Mentored nine undergraduate researchers in experimental design, research methodology, data collection, analysis, and scientific communication.
- Trained students in wet-lab research techniques (7 students) and computational methods (3 students).
- Guided students in scientific communication and poster development; (5 students presented research at scientific conferences)

Volunteer

Brain Awareness Week, UCLA BRI	**2024-2026**
The Compton Initiative, Compton	**2024-2026**
Habitat for Humanity, East Los Angeles	**2024-2025**
The Salvation Army, Santa Monica	**2022-2024**
Schmid Student Leadership Council Member	**2018-2020**